

Washington, DC

The best of the best in the capital — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition.

25

Michelin stars
in the 2025 DC
selection

28

Bib Gourmand
restaurants

2

bars on the 50
Best 2026
extended list

783

places
across
twelve lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 53

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Nightlife 50

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow

= you've been



Michelin star

Bib

Bib Gourmand

50 Best №1

bar ranking

W #1

Washingtonian 100 Very Best 2026

WP Washington Post 10 Best New 2026

closed

verify = check before you go

Resy

Tock

OpenTable

SevenRooms

where to book

Amex ✓

Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JBF 2026

James Beard nominee

\$-\$\$\$\$

rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic

Date night

Casual

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, The Washington Post, Washingtonian, OpenTable, Resy, Eater DC and the Michelin Guide. Michelin marks reflect the 2025 Washington, D.C. selection, the most recent at time of printing; only stars and Bib Gourmands are shown. Cover: the Washington Monument at dawn from the Reflecting Pool, via Pexels.

Tony *Abraham*

Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

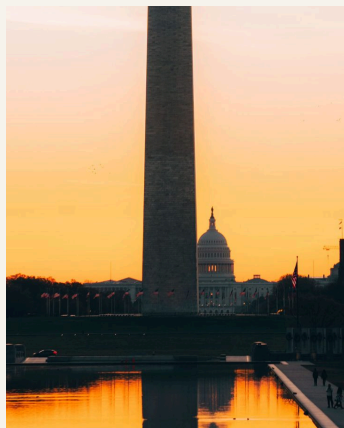
Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listede ville* / Washington, DC is the second city guide — built the same way as New York: every list cross-checked, every hard table given a backup, and the places you can only find here given room to breathe.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. Boston, Miami, Chicago, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle to follow.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.



Honor Roll • 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A half-smoke counter from 1958, a breakfast-taco window, a Shaw injera house and three starred dining rooms, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

Washington eats better than its reputation — twenty-odd stars, a deep Bib list, and the best Ethiopian and Indian cooking on the East Coast. These ten are where the Guide, Washingtonian's critics, the Beard committee and a few thousand Google reviews all point the same way, and where the food, not the room, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

Albi

01

Navy Yard; Michael Rafidi

★ W#1 NYT 4 stars new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Michael Rafidi's Levantine hearth is the city's best restaurant by most measures that matter — a star, Washingtonian's N°1 two years running, and a kitchen that treats Palestinian home cooking with the seriousness usually reserved for French. Everything passes through wood fire.

Order The sfeehe and the mushroom hummus with the pita, the kibbeh naya, then the lamb — whatever cut the hearth is doing. Finish with the kunafeh.

Rose's Luxury

02

Barracks Row

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Aaron Silverman's row house made Barracks Row a destination a decade ago and the food still earns the star: playful, precise, and built around a few dishes the city refuses to let him retire. The bar takes walk-ins the morning of.

Order The pork-and-lychee salad, the bread with miso cream, and whatever pasta is on. Sit at the bar and order à la carte if you can't face the full menu.

The Dabney

03

Blagden Alley; Jeremiah Langhorne; hearth

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Mid-Atlantic cooking from a wood-burning hearth in a Blagden Alley townhouse — the one starred room in DC where the vegetables are the reason people come back. Regional, seasonal, and smoky in the best way.

Order The hearth-roasted vegetables, the deviled eggs, the potato-roll sliders, and one large cut from the fire for the table. The bar, à la carte, is the relaxed way in.

Rasika

04

Penn Quarter / West End; the palak chaat

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Indian restaurant that taught Washington to book weeks ahead. The menu is modern but the cooking is grounded, and one dish — crisped spinach with yogurt, tamarind and dates — is on every list of the city's essential plates for a reason.

Order Palak chaat to start, no exceptions. Then the black cod, the chicken makhani and a mango lassi.

Tapori

05

H Street; Suresh Sundas' Indian street food

JB F 2026 Best Chef Mid-Atlantic finalist new

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Suresh Sundas' Bombay street-food room on H Street — pani puri, vada pav, dosa — cooked with a Beard finalist's technique and none of the restraint. New, loud, and already the Indian table Washingtonians send each other to.

Order Pani puri and the vada pav to start, the podi masala dosa, the lotus-root chaat, and the dum biryani for the table. Kulfi to finish.

Zaytinya

06

Penn Quarter; José Andrés

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

José Andrés' Turkish-Greek-Lebanese mezze room, twenty years old and still a Bib. It's the safe pick that turns out to be the right one: the bread comes out of the oven all night, and the small plates are consistent across a menu that runs to sixty.

Order The pita with olive oil and pomegranate, the kibbeh, the grilled octopus, the kofta, and the Turkish coffee cake. Order in waves.

Chercher

07

Shaw; Ethiopian

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Of the dozens of Ethiopian kitchens in a city that has the best outside Addis, this Shaw row house is the one to send a first-timer: soft, sour injera made fresh, stews with real depth, a lamb tibs that people cross town for.

Order A combination platter — split the meat and vegetarian sides so you get the misir wot, the gomen and the doro wot — plus the lamb tibs and a glass of tej.

La Tejana

08

Mount Pleasant; breakfast tacos

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Breakfast tacos from a window in Mount Pleasant, on flour tortillas made that morning, with a Bib to show Michelin noticed. The line on weekends is the neighborhood's social hour; go on a weekday and there isn't one.

Order The migas, the choripapa and the Tio Willie. Ask for salsa on everything and eat them on the sidewalk.

Ben's Chili Bowl

09

U Street; since 1958

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

The half-smoke — a coarse, snappy pork-and-beef sausage under chili — is Washington's one true native dish, and this U Street counter has served it since 1958, through riots, the Metro dig, and every president since Eisenhower. It's history you can eat in ten minutes.

Order The original half-smoke with chili, mustard and onions, chili cheese fries, and a vanilla shake. Late on a Friday is the right time.

2 Amys

10

Cathedral Heights; Peter Pastan

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Chef) \$\$

Walk-in

Late night

Group

Peter Pastan's Neapolitan pizzeria has been Washington's best for twenty-five years and this year the Beard Foundation finally put him up for Outstanding Chef. Certified D.O.C. pies from a wood oven, and a small-plates list that's quietly the better half of the menu.

Order The Margherita D.O.C. and the Norcia, plus the deviled eggs, the suppli and the salt cod fritters from the little-dishes board. No reservations; go before 6.



Cafés · 53 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Wine bars with real kitchens, bakeries that turn into restaurants at dusk, and the neighborhood rooms DC actually lives in.

DC's best neighborhood rooms are hybrids: Ellē is a bakery until five and a restaurant after; Bar del Monte is a corner Italian bar with pasta; Yellow is Albi's daytime face. The wine bars — Maxwell Park, Maison, Cork, Primrose — have kitchens serious enough to make dinner of.

Why these Picked for the room you'd return to on a weeknight. Two James Beard 2026 finalists (Maison Bar à Vins, Maxwell Park) and four Bibs. The old guard — Old Ebbitt, Martin's Tavern, Tabard Inn — stays because the rooms are irreplaceable.

Yellow

Georgetown / Navy Yard / Union Market;
Albi's daytime sibling

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Bar del Monte

Mount Pleasant; the Pastans' Italian bar
W#12 new \$\$ Walk-in
Date night

Ellē

Mount Pleasant; bakery by day, restaurant
by night
Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

La'Shukran

Union Market; Michael Rafidi's Levantine
bar
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Maison Bar à Vins

Logan Circle; natural wine bar
JBF 2026 Best New Restaurant finalist
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Residents Cafe & Bar

Dupont Circle; all-day
Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Unconventional Diner

Shaw
Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Your Only Friend

Mount Vernon Square; sandwiches +
cocktails
Bib new 2025 Bib \$\$ Resy
Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Le Diplomate

Logan Circle; the brasserie
\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Café Riggs

Penn Quarter; inside the Riggs hotel
\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Emma's Torch

Georgetown; refugee-staffed café-
restaurant
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

The Grace

Georgetown
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

La Merna

Adams Morgan
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Pizzeria Paradiso

Dupont / Georgetown; the original DC pizza
bar
\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Ama

Shaw; Johanna Hellrigl's Italian
JBF 2026 semifinalist new \$\$ Resy
Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Cucina Morini

Mount Vernon Square; Sicilian

W#10 **JBF 2026 semifinalist** new \$\$\$

Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Caruso's Grocery

Capitol Hill; red-sauce

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

The Wells

Capitol Hill; wine + oysters

new \$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

The Duck & The Peach

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

La Collina

Capitol Hill; Italian

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Rose's Luxury bar seats

Barracks Row; walk-in

★ \$\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Little Pearl

Capitol Hill; café by day, tasting counter by night

★ \$\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Bar Chinois

Mount Vernon Square

new \$\$

Date night

St. Anselm

Union Market; the tavern

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Bidwell

Union Market

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Buffalo & Bergen

Union Market; bagels + egg creams

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Rappahannock Oyster Bar

The Wharf

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night

Hank's Oyster Bar

Dupont / The Wharf / Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night

Old Ebbitt Grill

Downtown; since 1856

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Martin's Tavern

Georgetown; since 1933; the JFK proposal booth

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Bar Pilar

14th St

\$\$

Date night

Cork Wine Bar & Market

14th St

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night

Lulu's Wine Garden

U Street

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night

Maxwell Park

Shaw / Navy Yard; Brent Kroll's wine bar

JBF 2026

Outstanding Wine Program finalist \$\$

Walk-in

Date night Casual

Primrose

Brookland; French wine bar

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Chez Billy Sud

Georgetown

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Bistrot du Coin

Dupont Circle

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Le Chat Noir

Friendship Heights

verify \$\$

Date night Casual

Et Voila!

Palisades; Belgian

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Ruta del Vino

Petworth

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Timber Pizza

Petworth

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Little Coco's

Petworth

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Lapis

Adams Morgan; Afghan

Bib \$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Mintwood Place

closed

The Red Hen

Bloomingdale

Bib \$\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Boundary Stone

Bloomingdale

\$\$ Resy **Amex ✓**

Date night Casual

Tabard Inn

Dupont Circle; the fireplace

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Iron Gate

Dupont Circle; the garden

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Ala

Dupont Circle; Turkish

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Green Almond Pantry

Shaw; lunch-only; temporarily closed

[verify](#) \$\$

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

My Little Chamomile

Shaw; Cagla Onal-Urel's Turkish

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) new \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Beteseb

Adams Morgan; Ethiopian

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) new \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Busboys and Poets

14th St / multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)



Speakeasies · 50 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

A bank vault, a hotel library, a freezer door. Ranked, loosely, by how much you'll talk about it afterward.

DC does hidden bars well because it does hotels well: Silver Lyan is in the Riggs bank vault, Allegory behind a door in the Eaton's library, Off the Record beneath the Hay-Adams. The others hide behind pizza shops, doughnut counters and freezer doors.

Why these Ranked by the drink, not the door. Silver Lyan and Allegory placed on North America's 50 Best extended list this year; Service Bar was №23 the year before. The closed ones — Columbia Room, Never Looked Better — are listed so you know what the scene lost.

Silver Lyan

Riggs hotel vault, Penn Quarter; Mr Lyan

50 Best №55 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Allegory

behind a door in the Eaton hotel library

50 Best №57 \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Gibson

U Street; the original DC speakeasy

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Columbia Room

closed

Chicken + Whiskey

14th St; through the freezer door

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Left Door

14th St; the black door above Brookland Pint's old space

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Harold Black

Barracks Row; unmarked

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Denson Liquor Bar

Penn Quarter; downstairs

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Never Looked Better

closed

The Sheppard

Dupont Circle; through the pizza shop

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Green Zone

Adams Morgan; Middle Eastern cocktails

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Copycat Co.

H Street; Chinese street food + cocktails

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Providencia

H Street; Latin cocktails

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

L'Annexe

Georgetown; hidden bar under Chez Billy Sud

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Off the Record

Hay-Adams basement; the power bar

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Round Robin Bar

Willard InterContinental; since 1847

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Barmini

Penn Quarter; José Andrés' cocktail lab; reservation only

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Service Bar

U Street; 50 Best №23 in 2025

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Christine Kim) \$\$

Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Bar Cana

Adams Morgan; 2025 JBF Best New Bar semifinalist

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Jane Jane

14th St

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Death Punch

Adams Morgan; DC's Death & Co outpost

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Death & Co DC

Adams Morgan

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Dirty Habit

Hotel Monaco; the courtyard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Zeppelin

Shaw; back-room karaoke

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Morris American Bar

Shaw

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Archipelago

U Street; tiki

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Hank's Cocktail Bar

Dupont Circle

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Bar Charley

Dupont Circle

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

McClellan's Retreat

Dupont Circle; Civil War themed

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

The Tune Inn

Capitol Hill; dive with a hidden back room

\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Lost & Found

Shaw

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Wisdom

Capitol Hill; gin

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

La Jambe

Shaw; French wine + charcuterie

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Reveler's Hour

Adams Morgan; Tail Up Goat's wine bar; pasta

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

The Alibi

Adams Morgan

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Quarry House Tavern

Silver Spring; basement dive

\$\$

Date night

Late night

PX

Old Town Alexandria; the blue light = open

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Captain Gregory's

Old Town Alexandria; behind Sugar Shack doughnuts

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Next Whisky Bar

Watergate

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Barrel

Capitol Hill; bourbon bar upstairs, hidden downstairs

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Cane's back bar

H Street; rum

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Sotto's jazz nights

14th St

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Maxwell Park's back room

Shaw

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Quill

The Jefferson; the library bar

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Dram & Grain

Adams Morgan; beneath Jack Rose; reservation only

\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Dabney Cellar

Blagden Alley; the wine bar under The Dabney

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Calico

Blagden Alley; backyard bar

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Tiger Fork

Blagden Alley

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Crown & Crow

14th St; Sherlock's parlor

\$\$

Date night Late night

Sotto

14th St; the basement under Ghibellina

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night



Rooftops · 50 places

Rooftop bars

The Monument, the Capitol dome and the Potomac — DC's rooftops have better landmarks than almost any city's.

Height limits keep DC low, which means a sixth floor is a view. The good ones face the Monument (VUE, Ciel), the Kennedy Center and the river (Top of the Gate, 12 Stories), or the Capitol (Summit).

Why these Chosen for the view first. Where the drink is also the point — The Wild Days, Moonraker, Summit — it's noted. The Wharf and Navy Yard have most of the newer ones; Adams Morgan and U Street the older decks.

Summit

Conrad Washington DC; CityCenter

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

The Wild Days

Eaton DC

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Top of the Gate

Watergate Hotel; Kennedy Center views

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

VUE

Hotel Washington; the White House view

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Ciel Social Club

AC Hotel Downtown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

12 Stories

InterContinental, The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Whiskey Charlie

Canopy by Hilton, The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Officina

The Wharf; the rooftop terrazza

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

La Vie

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Moonraker

Pendry, The Wharf

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Flora Flora

Pendry, The Wharf

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Hi-Lawn

Union Market rooftop; lawn games

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Jackie

Navy Yard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

The Salt Line

Navy Yard; waterside

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Anchovy Social

Thompson Hotel, Navy Yard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Bar Élan

Navy Yard

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Brighton

Navy Yard; British pub rooftop

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Takoda

Shaw / Navy Yard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night Group

Hotel Zena's Hedy's Rooftop

Logan Circle

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

The Brixton

U Street

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Marvin

U Street; the roof deck

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

El Techo

Shaw; Latin rooftop, Rito Loco

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Kingfisher

Adams Morgan

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Jack Rose Dining Saloon terrace

Adams Morgan; 2,700 whiskeys

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Perry's

Adams Morgan; the original rooftop; drag brunch

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Mission

Dupont Circle

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Dirty Habit courtyard

Hotel Monaco

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

POV

closed (now VUE)

Crimson View

Motto by Hilton, Chinatown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

The Graham Rooftop

Georgetown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Tony & Joe's

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Sequoia

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Lady Bird

The Banneker, Downtown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Ambar's roof

Capitol Hill / Clarendon

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Kaliwa's Wharf terrace

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Mi Vida

The Wharf / District Wharf; upper deck

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Cantina Bambina

The Wharf; pier bar

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Del Mar

The Wharf; Fabio Trabocchi; terrace

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Bar Deco

Chinatown; rooftop

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

DNV Rooftop

Donovan Hotel, Thomas Circle

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Embassy Row Hotel rooftop pool

Dupont Circle

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Cortez

Shaw; rooftop

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Tiki TNT

The Wharf; rooftop

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Roofers Union

Adams Morgan; roof deck

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Kirwan's on the Wharf

The Wharf; upstairs

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Hank's on the Wharf rooftop

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Uptowner Cafe roof

Adams Morgan

verify \$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

The Brig

Navy Yard; beer garden, open-air

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Dacha Beer Garden

Shaw / Navy Yard; open-air

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Wunder Garten

NoMa; open-air

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)



Bars · 105 places

Bars

Two on the 50 Best extended list, a Beard-nominated wine bar, and the power bars where the deals are actually done.

A serious cocktail city: the Gibson started it, Service Bar and Jack Rose kept it honest, and the hotels imported London and New York talent. The dives — Tune Inn, Raven, Dan's — are as important as the cocktail rooms.

Why these Ranked and recognized first, then institutions, hotel bars, dives, wine, beer. The test: would someone who drinks here send a visiting friend? Off the Record and Round Robin are on for history; Maxwell Park for the wine; ChurchKey and Bluejacket for the beer.

Ranked & recognized

Silver Lyan

Penn Quarter

50 Best N°55

\$\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic

Date night

Allegory

Downtown

50 Best N°57

\$\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic

Date night

Service Bar

U Street

50 Best N°23 in 2025

JBF 2026 semifinalist

\$\$

Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Maxwell Park

Shaw / Navy Yard

JBF 2026

Outstanding Wine Program finalist

\$\$

Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Maison Bar à Vins

Logan Circle

JBF 2026

Best New Restaurant finalist

new

\$\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Bar Cana

Adams Morgan

new

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Barmini

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$\$

Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic

Date night

Cocktail institutions

The Gibson

U Street

\$\$

Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Jack Rose Dining Saloon

Adams Morgan; the whiskey library

\$\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Copycat Co.

H Street

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Providencia

H Street

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Green Zone

Adams Morgan

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Death & Co DC

Adams Morgan

new

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Death Punch

Adams Morgan

new

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Left Door

14th St

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Chicken + Whiskey

14th St

\$\$

Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Jane Jane

14th St

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Charley

Dupont Circle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Hank's Cocktail Bar

Dupont Circle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Sheppard

Dupont Circle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Harold Black

Barracks Row

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Wisdom

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Denson Liquor Bar

Penn Quarter

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lost & Found

Shaw

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Morris American Bar

Shaw

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Zeppelin

Shaw

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Archipelago

U Street; tiki

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Dirty Habit

Penn Quarter

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Spero

Capitol Crossing; Johnny Spero

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Élan

Navy Yard

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bernadette's

Union Market; above The Oak Room; supper club

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Oak Room bar

Union Market

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lucky Buns

Adams Morgan; burgers + bar

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Pop's SeaBar

Adams Morgan

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Alibi

Adams Morgan

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

L'Annexe

Georgetown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Reveler's Hour

Adams Morgan

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Hotel & classic bars

Off the Record

Hay-Adams

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Round Robin Bar

Willard

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

The Next Whisky Bar

Watergate

\$\$

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Quill

The Jefferson

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Bourbon Steak bar

Four Seasons Georgetown

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Rye Bar

Rosewood Georgetown

verify \$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bazaar bar

Waldorf Astoria; José Andrés

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Peacock Alley

Waldorf Astoria

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Marcus DC bar

Salamander; Marcus Samuelsson

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Anthony Jones)

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Dōgon bar

Salamander; Kwame Onwuachi

new \$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lyle's / Lyle Hotel bar

Dupont

verify \$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Morrow's Le Clou

NoMa

verify \$\$

Date night Late night

Riggs' Café Riggs bar

Penn Quarter

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar at the Line

Adams Morgan; the church

verify \$\$

Date night Late night

St. Regis Bar

Downtown

\$\$

Date night Late night

Doyle bar at The Dupont Circle Hotel

\$\$

Date night Late night

Quadrant

Ritz-Carlton West End

\$\$

Date night Late night

Lobby Bar at the Conrad

\$\$

Date night Late night

Historic / dive / neighborhood

The Tune Inn

Capitol Hill; since 1947

\$ Walk-in

Late night

The Raven Grill

Mount Pleasant; oldest bar in DC

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Dan's Cafe

Adams Morgan; pour-your-own

\$ Walk-in

Late night

The Pug

H Street

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Little Miss Whiskey's Golden Dollar

H Street

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Rock & Roll Hotel

closed

Solly's Tavern

U Street

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Saloon

U Street; no standing, no TV, no shots

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Showtime Lounge

Bloomingdale

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Wonderland Ballroom

Columbia Heights

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Red Derby

Columbia Heights

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Marx Cafe

Mount Pleasant

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Trusty's

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Kramers

Dupont Circle; bookstore bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Big Hunt

Dupont Circle

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Fox & Hounds

Dupont Circle

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Ivy and Coney

Shaw; Detroit meets Chicago

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Sonny's Pizza

Park View; bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Hitching Post

Petworth; bar side

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Slash Run

Petworth; burgers + metal

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Looking Glass Lounge

Petworth

\$ Walk-in

Late night

The Passenger

closed

Never Looked Better

closed

Wine bars

Maxwell Park

Shaw / Navy Yard

JBF 2026 finalist \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Maison Bar à Vins

Logan Circle

JBF 2026 finalist new \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Cork

14th St

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Primrose

Brookland

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lulu's Wine Garden

U Street

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

La Jambe

Shaw

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Wells

Capitol Hill

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Ruta del Vino

Petworth

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Vin 909

Annapolis; worth the drive

\$\$

Date night Late night

Dio Wine Bar

H Street

\$\$

Date night Late night

Pearl Dive Oyster Palace

14th St; oysters + wine

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Beer

Bluejacket

Navy Yard; brewery

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Right Proper Brewing

Shaw / Brookland

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

ChurchKey

14th St; 555 beers

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Atlas Brew Works

Ivy City / Navy Yard

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Red Bear Brewing

NoMa

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Other Half DC

Ivy City

new \$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Hellbender

Brookland

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Sovereign

Georgetown; Belgian beer

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Meridian Pint

Petworth

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Pizzeria Paradiso's beer list

Dupont

\$\$

Date night Late night

Port City Brewing

Alexandria

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Rooftop / view bars that double as great bars

Summit at the Conrad

\$\$

Date night Late night

Top of the Gate

Watergate

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Wild Days

Eaton

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

VUE

Hotel Washington

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

12 Stories

The Wharf

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night



Coffee · 51 places

Coffee shops

A hometown roaster on every corner, Ethiopian coffee ceremonies, and the bakeries that double as the best cafés.

Compass Coffee is the hometown roaster; Sidamo and Idido pour Ethiopian coffee the way it's meant to be poured; and the best cafés are often bakeries — Yellow, Ellê, Bread Furst, Seylou.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. Tryst is the couch café that defined Adams Morgan; Swing's has been roasting since 1916; Ching Ching Cha is the tea house you'll want on a rainy Georgetown afternoon.

Yellow

Georgetown / Navy Yard / Union Market

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Compass Coffee

multiple; the DC roaster

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Tatte

multiple; Boston import

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

The Coffee Bar

Logan Circle

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sidamo Coffee & Tea

H Street; Ethiopian

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Little Red Fox

Van Ness

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Qualia Coffee

Petworth; roaster

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Lost Sock Roasters

Takoma / Mount Pleasant

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Vigilante Coffee

Hyattsville / College Park

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Colada Shop

14th St / The Wharf; Cuban

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Baked & Wired

Georgetown

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Blue Bottle

Georgetown / Union Station

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

La Colombe

Blagden Alley / Chinatown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Slipstream

14th St / Navy Yard

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Peregrine Espresso

Eastern Market / Union Market

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Emissary

Dupont Circle

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Un Je Ne Sais Quoi

Dupont Circle; French pastry + coffee

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Zeke's Coffee

Brookland; roaster

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Dua Coffee

Downtown; Indonesian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

For Five Coffee Roasters

Downtown / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Swing's Coffee

Downtown; since 1916

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tryst

Adams Morgan; the couch café

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Philz Coffee

Adams Morgan / Navy Yard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bluestone Lane

Georgetown / Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Grace Street Coffee

Georgetown; roaster

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boulangerie Christophe

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ching Ching Cha

Georgetown; tea house

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Teaism

Penn Quarter / Dupont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ceremony Coffee

Annapolis / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Wydown

14th St / H Street

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Big Bear Cafe

Bloomingdale

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ellē

Mount Pleasant; the café side

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Bread Furst

Van Ness; Mark Furstenberg

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Seylou

Shaw; whole-grain bakery + coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Rose Ave Bakery

Downtown; Asian-American pastry + coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Pluma by Bluebird

Union Market

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Coffee Republic

Downtown

\$

Sweets Brunch

Killer ESP

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Misha's

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Northside Social

Clarendon

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Idido Coffee

Arlington; Ethiopian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bakers & Baristas

Chinatown / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Café Georgetown

Georgetown; Turkish coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sankofa Video Books & Café

Howard; Ethiopian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Filter Coffeehouse

Dupont / Foggy Bottom

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Colony Club

Park View

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

The Potter's House

Adams Morgan

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Three Fifty Bakery & Coffee

Dupont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ebenezers Coffeehouse

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Radici

Capitol Hill; Italian market

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dolcezza

multiple; gelato + coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Restaurants · 164 places

Restaurants

Twenty-five Michelin stars, twenty-eight Bibs, the first four-star NYT restaurant outside New York — and Ethiopian, Salvadoran and Lao cooking you won't find better anywhere in America.

Twenty-five stars in the 2025 Michelin selection — three of them two-star — and twenty-eight Bibs, cross-checked against Washingtonian's 100 Very Best, where Albi is Nº1, and the Post's 10 Best New Restaurants under new critic Elazar Sontag.

Why these Grouped by distinction: stars, Bibs, the new guard, then the classics. Your in-progress list is all here — Zaytinya, Rasika, Anju, Daru, L'Ardente, Causa, Imperfecto — with Makan and Cranes struck through. The Bib section and the Ethiopian block are the two to read slowly.

Michelin ★★

minibar by José Andrés

Penn Quarter

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Jônt

Logan Circle; above Bresca

★★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Inn at Little Washington

Washington, VA; 90 min

★★ (down from ★★★) \$\$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Michelin ★

Albi

Navy Yard; Michael Rafidi

★ W#1 NYT 4 stars new \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Bresca

14th St; Ryan Ratino

★

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Hospitality)

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Causa

Blagden Alley; Carlos Delgado, 2025 JBF Best Chef

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Dabney

Blagden Alley; Jeremiah Langhorne; hearth

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Elcielo

Union Market; Colombian

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Fiola

Penn Quarter; Fabio Trabocchi

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Gravitas

Ivy City; Matt Baker

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night

Imperfecto

West End; Enrique Limardo

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Kinship

Mount Vernon Square; Eric Ziebold

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Little Pearl

Capitol Hill

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Masseria

Union Market; Nicholas Stefanelli

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mita

Shaw; plant-based Latin tasting

★ JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$\$

Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Métier

Mount Vernon Square; below Kinship

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Omakase at Barracks Row

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Oyster Oyster

Shaw; vegetable tasting

★ \$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Pineapple & Pearls

Capitol Hill; Aaron Silverman

★ (down from ★★) \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Rania

Penn Quarter; Indian

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Rooster & Owl

Columbia Heights

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Rose's Luxury

Barracks Row

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic

Sushi Nakazawa DC

Trump / Waldorf Astoria building, Federal Triangle

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Xiquet by Danny Lledó

Glover Park; Valencian

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Tail Up Goat

closed (2025)

Reverie

closed (Oct 2025)

Cranes

closed (Feb 2026)

Maydan

14th St; live fire

no longer starred; still essential \$\$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Date night Romantic Group

Bib Gourmand (2025)

Zaytinya

Penn Quarter; José Andrés

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Daru

H Street; Suresh Sundas

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

L'Ardente

Capitol Crossing; the 40-layer lasagna

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Amparo Fondita

Dupont Circle; Mexican

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Astoria DC

Dupont Circle; Asian

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Cane

H Street; Trinidadian

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Dauphine's

Downtown; New Orleans

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Ellē

Mount Pleasant

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Hitching Post

Petworth; fried chicken

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Ivy City Smokehouse

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Karma Modern Indian

Downtown

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

La Tejana

Mount Pleasant; breakfast tacos

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Laos in Town

NoMa

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Lapis

Adams Morgan; Afghan

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Maketto

H Street; Cambodian-Taiwanese

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Menya Hosaki

Petworth; ramen

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Oyamel

Penn Quarter; José Andrés

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

PhoXotic

Bloomington

Bib new 2025 Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Queen's English

Columbia Heights; Hong Kong

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Residents Cafe & Bar

Dupont Circle

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sababa

Cleveland Park; Israeli

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Stellina Pizzeria

Union Market / multiple

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Taqueria Habanero

Columbia Heights / 14th St

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

The Red Hen

Bloomingdale

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Toki Underground

H Street; ramen

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Unconventional Diner

Shaw

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Yellow

multiple

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Your Only Friend

Mount Vernon Square

Bib new 2025 **Bib** \$\$\$ Resy
Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Makan

closed

Washington Post 10 Best New
2026, Resy Hit List & the new
guard

The Oak Room

Union Market; Tim Hollingsworth's grill;
prime rib

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night Group

Bernadette's

Union Market; the supper club upstairs

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Marcus DC

Salamander; Marcus Samuelsson

JBF 2026 semifinalist new \$\$\$
Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Dōgon

Salamander; Kwame Onwuachi; Afro-
Caribbean

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Group

Chai Pani

Union Market; Meherwan Irani

JBF 2026
Outstanding Restaurateur finalist new \$\$
Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night Group

Tapori

H Street; Suresh Sundas' Indian street food

JBF 2026 *Best Chef Mid-Atlantic finalist*
new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Moon Rabbit

Penn Quarter; Kevin Tien; Vietnamese

JBF 2026
Outstanding Pastry Chef finalist (Susan Bae)
new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Centrolina

CityCenter; Amy Brandwein

**JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding
Restaurant)**
\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Cucina Morini

Mount Vernon Square

W#10 new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Bar del Monte

Mount Pleasant

W#12 new \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night

Pascual

Capitol Hill; wood-fired Mexican

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Gemini

Cleveland Park; Italian

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

La'Shukran

Union Market

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Ama

Shaw

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Beteseb

Adams Morgan; Ethiopian

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Brasero Atlantico

Downtown; Argentine grill

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Boogy & Peel

Dupont Circle; Detroit-style pizza

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Desert 5

Union Market; ribs + line dancing

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night Group

Emma's Torch

Georgetown

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

The Grace

Georgetown

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

La Merna

Adams Morgan

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Osteria Mozza DC

Georgetown; Nancy Silverton, 2026 JBF
Lifetime Achievement

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Romantic](#)

Bar Spero

Capitol Crossing; Johnny Spero

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Shoto

Midtown Center; Japanese, the scene

new \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

The Bazaar by José Andrés

Waldorf Astoria

new \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Amazonia

Shaw; Carlos Delgado's Amazonian

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Hiraya

Eckington; Filipino

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Botiwalla

Union Market; Chai Pani's kebab sibling

new 2026 \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Cappelini's

chicken parm

new 2026 \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Bizzaria

pizza

new 2026 \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Marv's Dogs

Chicago dogs; from Cork's owners

new 2026 \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Hijos del Maíz

Rockville; masa taco trailer

new 2026 \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Classics & must-visits (no Michelin mark)

Rasika

Penn Quarter / West End; the palak chaat

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Romantic](#)

Anju

Dupont Circle; Korean; Fried Rice Collective

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Chiko

Capitol Hill / Dupont; Korean-Chinese

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

I Egg You

Dupont; breakfast sandwiches

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Le Diplomate

Logan Circle

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Romantic](#) [Group](#)

2 Amys

Cathedral Heights; Peter Pastan

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Chef)

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Etto

14th St

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Ghostburger

Shaw

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Lutèce

Georgetown; French small plates

[verify](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Thip Khao

Columbia Heights; Lao

[verify](#) \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Alhambra

Spanish

[verify](#) \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Roaming Rooster

multiple; fried chicken

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Love, Makoto

Downtown; food hall by Makoto Okuwa

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Kaliwa

The Wharf; Filipino-Thai-Korean

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Del Mar

The Wharf; Spanish seafood

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Fiola Mare

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Sfoglina

Van Ness / Rosslyn / Downtown; pasta

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Nina May

Shaw

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Opal

Chevy Chase

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Ellington Park Bistro

Dupont

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Bombay Club

Downtown; since 1988

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

The Bombay Street Food

Columbia Heights

verify \$\$

Casual Date night

Indique

Cleveland Park

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bindaas

Cleveland Park / Foggy Bottom

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Ambar

Capitol Hill / Clarendon; Balkan; unlimited small plates

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Compass Rose

14th St; global street food

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Doi Moi

14th St; Southeast Asian

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bad Saint

closed

Little Serow

closed

Komi

closed

Sushi Taro

Dupont Circle; kaiseki

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sushi Capitol

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Rakuya

Dupont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Tonari

Chinatown; Japanese-Italian

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Daikaya

Chinatown; ramen + izakaya

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bantam King

Chinatown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Reren Lamen & Bar

Chinatown

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Hong Kong Pearl

Falls Church; dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Peter Chang

Arlington / Rockville; Sichuan

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Tiger Fork

Blagden Alley; Hong Kong + cocktails

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Hazel

Shaw

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Convivial

Shaw

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Chercher

Shaw; Ethiopian

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Zenebech

Shaw; Ethiopian

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Dukem

U Street; Ethiopian

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Ethiopic

H Street

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Ben's Chili Bowl

U Street; since 1958

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Florida Avenue Grill

U Street; since 1944

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Georgia Brown's

Downtown; Lowcountry

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Old Ebbitt Grill

Downtown

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night Group

The Occidental

Downtown; reopened

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Joe's Seafood, Prime Steak & Stone Crab

Downtown

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Charlie Palmer Steak

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bourbon Steak

Georgetown

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Capital Grille

Penn Quarter

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

BLT Steak

Downtown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Ray's the Steaks

Arlington

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Filomena

Georgetown; the Christmas decorations

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

1789

Georgetown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Clyde's of Georgetown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Founding Farmers

Foggy Bottom / multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Farmers Fishers Bakers

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Busboys and Poets

multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Belga Cafe

Capitol Hill; Belgian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

The Smith

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Date night

Ted's Bulletin

Capitol Hill / multiple; homemade Pop-Tarts

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Rappahannock Oyster Bar

The Wharf

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Pearl Dive Oyster Palace

14th St

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Hank's Oyster Bar

multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

The Salt Line

Navy Yard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Ivy City Smokehouse

Ivy City

Bib \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

2Fifty BBQ

Riverdale, MD; Texas-style

JBFB 2026 semifinalist \$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Federalist Pig

Adams Morgan; BBQ

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Hill Country

Penn Quarter

[verify](#) \$\$

Casual Date night

Field & Main

Marshall, VA; worth the drive

JBFB 2026 finalist \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night



Brunch · 55 places

Brunch spots

The city that invented the political brunch — Founding Farmers to drag brunch at Perry's.

DC treats brunch as a civic institution. The bookable classics — Founding Farmers, Le Diplomate — and the neighborhood ones you walk into: Ted's Bulletin, The Diner, the drag brunches at Perry's and Nellie's.

Why these Kept your eight and added the places that top Resy and OpenTable's weekend demand. Yellow, Unconventional Diner, La Tejana, Residents and Ellē are Bibs; Imperfecto and Little Pearl are starred. The Coupe is flagged to verify.

Founding Farmers

Foggy Bottom; the one everyone books

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Le Diplomate

Logan Circle

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Belga Cafe

Capitol Hill; Belgian waffles

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

The Smith

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Busboys and Poets

multiple

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

The Coupe

Columbia Heights

verify \$\$

Brunch

Ala

Dupont Circle; Turkish breakfast

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Imperfecto

West End; brunch tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Yellow

multiple

[Bib](#) \$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Unconventional Diner

Shaw

[Bib](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Residents Cafe & Bar

Dupont

[Bib](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

La Tejana

Mount Pleasant; breakfast tacos

[Bib](#) \$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Ellē

Mount Pleasant

[Bib](#) \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Ted's Bulletin

Capitol Hill / multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

The Diner

Adams Morgan; 24 hours

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Tryst

Adams Morgan

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Perry's

Adams Morgan; drag brunch

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Nellie's

U Street; drag brunch

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Farmers Fishers Bakers

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Baked & Wired

Georgetown

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Martin's Tavern

Georgetown

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Café Riggs

Penn Quarter

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Old Ebbitt Grill

Downtown; oyster brunch

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Zaytinya brunch

Penn Quarter

Bib \$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Oyamel brunch

Penn Quarter

Bib \$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Ambar

Capitol Hill; unlimited brunch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Bidwell

Union Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

St. Anselm

Union Market

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Buffalo & Bergen

Union Market

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Pluma by Bluebird

Union Market

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

The Duck & The Peach

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Little Pearl brunch

Capitol Hill

★ \$\$\$

Brunch

Bar del Monte weekend

Mount Pleasant

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Iron Gate

Dupont; garden brunch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Tabard Inn

Dupont; the doughnuts

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Bistrot du Coin

Dupont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Kramers

Dupont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Emissary

Dupont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

I Egg You

Dupont

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Lucky Buns

Adams Morgan

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Chez Billy Sud

Georgetown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Boulangerie Christophe

Georgetown

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Un Je Ne Sais Quoi

Dupont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Colada Shop

14th St / The Wharf

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Del Mar brunch

The Wharf

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Officina

The Wharf

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Anchovy Social

Navy Yard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

The Salt Line

Navy Yard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Cane

H Street; Sunday

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Dauphine's

Downtown; Creole brunch

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Marcus DC brunch

Salamander

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Osteria Morini

Navy Yard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Duke's Grocery

Dupont / multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Bob & Edith's

Arlington; 24 hours

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Pete's Diner

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch



Off-beat · 51 places

Off-beat & only-in-DC

Half-smokes, mumbo sauce, the oldest fish market in America, and the Senate cafeteria.

Half-smokes at Ben's since 1958, fried whiting at Horace & Dickie's, the Maine Avenue Fish Market that predates the Wharf by a century, the largest Ethiopian community outside Africa, and the two cafeterias every tourist should know about.

Why these Selected for singularity — things that could only be here — plus the street-level classics any local would insist on. Hitching Post, La Tejana and Toki Underground carry Bibs; Eden Center is the one that justifies a car.

Ben's Chili Bowl

U Street; the half-smoke, since 1958

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Florida Avenue Grill

U Street; since 1944

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Horace & Dickie's

H Street; fried whiting, since 1990

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Henry's Soul Cafe

U Street; sweet potato pie

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Dukem

U Street

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Zenebech

Shaw

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Chercher

Shaw

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Ethiopic

H Street

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Beteseb

Adams Morgan

new \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Eden Center

Falls Church; Vietnamese mall

the drive \$ Walk-in

Casual

Hong Kong Pearl

Falls Church; dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Eastern Market

Capitol Hill; Market Lunch's bluebucks pancakes

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Market Lunch

Eastern Market

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Union Market

NoMa; the hall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Maine Avenue Fish Market

The Wharf; oldest open-air fish market in the US

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Jessie Taylor Seafood

Fish Market

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Captain White's

Fish Market

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hitching Post

Petworth; behind the Old Soldiers' Home

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

La Tejana

Mount Pleasant; breakfast tacos from a window

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Taqueria Habanero

Columbia Heights

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

El Rey

U Street; tacos + patio

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Los Hermanos

Columbia Heights; Dominican

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Amsterdam Falafelshop

Adams Morgan; the toppings bar

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Jumbo Slice

Adams Morgan; 2am

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Pizza Mart

Adams Morgan; the jumbo slice

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Lucky Buns

Adams Morgan

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Wiseguy Pizza

Chinatown / Navy Yard; NY slices

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Andy's Pizza

Foggy Bottom / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Call Your Mother Deli

Park View / multiple; the Jew-ish deli

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Bullfrog Bagels

H Street / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Pretzel Bakery

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Crumbs & Whiskers

Georgetown; cat café

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Dan's Cafe

Adams Morgan; pour-your-own

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Toki Underground

H Street; up the stairs

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Ivy and Coney

Shaw

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Ghostburger

Shaw

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual

Mr. Braxton

Park View

verify \$
Casual

Kith/Kin

closed

Momofuku CCDC

closed

Sonny's Pizza

Park View

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Hip City Veg

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Cava original

Rockville / multiple; started here

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Sweetgreen original

Georgetown; started here

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Georgetown Cupcake

Georgetown; the line on M Street

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Sugar Shack Donuts

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Captain Gregory's

behind the doughnut shop

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Mount Vernon Inn

Mount Vernon, VA; peanut soup

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Bethesda Crab House

Bethesda; newspaper tables

\$ Walk-in
Casual

The Congressional cafeterias

Longworth

the tourist's secret \$
Casual

Supreme Court cafeteria

the other tourist's secret \$ Walk-in
Casual

Quarterdeck

Arlington; crabs on the deck

\$ Walk-in
Casual



Bakeries · 51 places

Bakeries

Stone-milled loaves, Georgetown's cupcake line, and the pistachio sticky bun that changed DC breakfast.

Bread Furst's Mark Furstenberg won the James Beard Outstanding Baker award and set the standard; Seylou mills its own grain; Yellow's pistachio sticky bun is the city's most-photographed breakfast.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one signature item each. Georgetown Cupcake stays for the line; Baked & Wired stays for being what locals order instead. Milk Bar and Ladurée are flagged to verify.

Bread Furst

Van Ness; Mark Furstenberg, 2017 JBF Outstanding Baker

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Seylou

Shaw; whole-grain, stone-milled

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Baked & Wired

Georgetown

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Georgetown Cupcake

Georgetown; the line

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sprinkles

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Rose Ave Bakery

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Un Je Ne Sais Quoi

Dupont Circle

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Boulangerie Christophe

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Fresh Baguette

Bethesda / Georgetown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Le Caprice DC

Columbia Heights

verify \$
Sweets Brunch

Bakers & Baristas

Chinatown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Lyon Bakery

Union Market

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Buffalo & Bergen

Union Market; bagels

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Call Your Mother Deli

multiple; bagels

new \$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bullfrog Bagels

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Pearl's Bagels

Mount Vernon Square / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bethesda Bagels

Bethesda / Dupont

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

The Pretzel Bakery

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Paul

Penn Quarter / multiple; French

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Tatte

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Yellow

multiple; pistachio sticky bun

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Ellē

Mount Pleasant

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Pluma by Bluebird

Union Market

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Little Red Fox

Van Ness

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Heidelberg Pastry Shoppe

Arlington; German, since 1975

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Best Buns

Shirlington

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sugar Shack Donuts

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

District Doughnut

Barracks Row / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Astro Doughnuts & Fried Chicken

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Donut Run

Takoma; vegan

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Duck Donuts

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sticky Fingers

Columbia Heights; vegan

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Buttercream Bakeshop

Shaw

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Baked by Yael

Woodley Park; cakepops

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Firehook Bakery

Cleveland Park / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Marvelous Market

closed

Levain DC

Georgetown / Bethesda

new \$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Milk Bar DC

Logan Circle

verify \$
Sweets Brunch

Sweet Lobby

Barracks Row; macarons

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Ladurée Georgetown

verify \$
Sweets Brunch

Fluffy Thoughts

McLean; cakes

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

A Baked Joint

Mount Vernon Square

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bakeshop

Clarendon

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

~~Mah-Ze-Dahr~~

closed (DC)

Bread & Water Company

Union Market

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bakehouse

Old Town Alexandria

verify \$
Sweets Brunch

Chinatown Express bakery counter

Chinatown; noodles + buns

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Patisserie Poupon

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Praline Bakery

Bethesda

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Rise Bakery

Adams Morgan; gluten-free

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Whisked!

Union Market; pies

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch



Dessert • 52 places

Dessert bars & sweets

For after — or instead of — dinner.

Gelato counters, museum cafés worth the ticket, and a James Beard-nominated pastry chef at a Vietnamese restaurant.

Why these Ice Cream Jubilee and Dolcezza anchor the list; Sweet Home Café and Mitsitam are the two museum cafés that are destinations in themselves; Moon Rabbit's Susan Bae is the pastry chef to plan around.

Ice Cream Jubilee

Navy Yard / 14th St

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Jeni's

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Van Leeuwen

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Dolcezza

multiple; gelato + coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Pitango Gelato

Penn Quarter / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Larry's Homemade Ice Cream

Dupont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mount Desert Island Ice Cream

Mount Pleasant / Shaw

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Thomas Sweet

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Moorenko's

Silver Spring / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Milk Bar

Logan Circle

verify \$

Sweets

Georgetown Cupcake

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Baked & Wired

Georgetown; the cupcakes locals prefer

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Sweet Lobby

Barracks Row

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Un Je Ne Sais Quoi

Dupont; the pastry case

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Rose Ave Bakery

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ching Ching Cha

Georgetown; tea + sweets

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Teaism

Penn Quarter; salty oat cookies

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Tatte

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Chocolate Chocolate

Downtown; since 1984

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fleurir Chocolates

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

The Chocolate House

Dupont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Kilwins

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sugar Shack Donuts

Old Town Alexandria

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Astro Doughnuts

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

District Doughnut

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ted's Bulletin

homemade Pop-Tarts

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Kung Fu Tea

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Tsaocaa

multiple; bubble tea

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mochi Ring

multiple; mochi doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Paris Baguette

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sweet Home Café

National Museum of African American History and Culture

\$\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mitsitam Cafe

National Museum of the American Indian

\$\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Riggs' Café Riggs desserts

Penn Quarter

\$

Sweets

Moon Rabbit's pastry

Penn Quarter; Susan Bae

JBF 2026 finalist \$

Sweets

Bresca's dessert counter

14th St

\$

Sweets

Jônt's mignardises

Logan Circle

★★★ \$\$\$\$

Sweets

Pineapple & Pearls

Capitol Hill

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Sweets

Little Pearl

Capitol Hill; pastries by day

★ \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Yellow

pistachio sticky bun

Bib \$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Ellē

Mount Pleasant

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Bread Furst

Van Ness

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Seylou

Shaw

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Buttercream Bakeshop

Shaw

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Baked by Yael

Woodley Park

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sticky Fingers

Columbia Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Donut Run

Takoma

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sprinkles

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Levain DC

Georgetown

new \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Salt & Straw DC

verify \$

Sweets

Insomnia Cookies

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sarah's Handmade Ice Cream

Bethesda

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Nicecream

Clarendon; nitrogen

\$ Walk-in

Sweets



Scene · 51 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: the Waldorf, the Salamander, and the Georgetown tables where diplomats eat.

Where the room is the point: the Waldorf's Bazaar and Peacock Alley, the Salamander's Marcus and Dōgon, Café Milano for the ambassadors, and the Georgetown waterfront in summer.

Why these The hotel rooms lead — this is DC — then the see-and-be-seen circuit from Penn Quarter to Georgetown. Fiola carries a star; the rest earn their place on the room, the crowd, or the view.

The Bazaar by José Andrés

Waldorf Astoria

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Peacock Alley

Waldorf Astoria

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Shoto

Midtown Center

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Marcus DC

Salamander

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Dōgon

Salamander

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Bernadette's

Union Market; supper club

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Oak Room

Union Market

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Fiola

Penn Quarter

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Fiola Mare

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Del Mar

The Wharf

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Le Diplomate

Logan Circle

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Osteria Mozza

Georgetown

new \$\$\$

Group Date night

Bourbon Steak

Four Seasons

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Cut by Wolfgang Puck

Rosewood Georgetown

verify \$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Café Milano

Georgetown; the diplomats

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Occidental

Downtown

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Old Ebbitt Grill

Downtown

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Off the Record

Hay-Adams

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Round Robin Bar

Willard

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Quill

The Jefferson

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Greenhouse at The Jefferson

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Plume

closed

Charlie Palmer Steak

Capitol Hill; the lobbyists

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Group](#)

Bombay Club

Downtown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Rasika West End

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Ambar

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Barcelona Wine Bar

14th St / Cathedral Heights

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Whiskey Charlie

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Salt Line

Navy Yard; game nights

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Mi Vida

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Kaliwa

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Hank's Oyster Bar

The Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Tony & Joe's

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Sequoia

Georgetown Waterfront

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Nobu DC

West End

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Group](#)

Rare Steakhouse & Tavern

Downtown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Joe's Seafood

Downtown

\$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Hamilton

Downtown; live music

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Ned's Club

Downtown; members

new \$\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

[Romantic](#) [Group](#)

The LINE DC lobby

Adams Morgan

\$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Eaton lobby & Wild Days

Downtown

\$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Riggs

Penn Quarter; Café Riggs + Silver Lyan

\$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Morrow

NoMa

verify \$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Lyle

Dupont; hotel bar

verify \$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Salamander DC

Southwest

\$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Pendry Wharf

Moonraker / Flora Flora

new \$\$\$

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Zaytinya

Penn Quarter; the room

Bib \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Jaleo

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

China Chilcano

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)

Oyamel

Penn Quarter

Bib \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

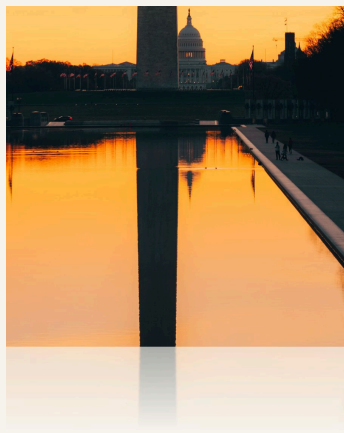
[Group](#) [Date night](#)

The Lafayette at the Hay-Adams

the power breakfast

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Group](#) [Date night](#)



Nightlife · 50 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

U Street's stages, the Wharf's venues, and a megaclub in Northeast.

DC's nightlife is music first: the 9:30 Club, the Anthem, Black Cat, Blues Alley since 1965. The dance floors are Flash for techno, Echostage for the big rooms, and U Street for everything in between.

Why these Venues and clubs together, because that's how the night works here. U Street Music Hall, Town and Rock & Roll Hotel are listed closed so you know what's gone; Eighteenth Street Lounge is back on U Street.

U Street Music Hall

closed

9:30 Club

U Street; the venue

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Black Cat

14th St

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Flash

Shaw; techno

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Decades

Dupont Circle; four floors

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Soundcheck

Downtown

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Echostage

Northeast; the megaclub

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Club Glow at Echostage

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bliss

Northeast

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

The Park at 14th

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Rosebar

Dupont

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Ultrabar

Downtown

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Abigail

Dupont

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Heist

Dupont

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Cafe Citron

Dupont; Latin

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Nellie's Sports Bar

U Street

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Number Nine

Logan Circle

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Trade

14th St

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Pitchers / A League of Her Own

Adams Morgan

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Kiki

Shaw

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Shakers

Shaw

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Bunker

Downtown

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Town Danceboutique

closed

Green Lantern

Downtown

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

DC9

U Street

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Velvet Lounge

U Street

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Marvin

U Street

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Late night Group

The Brixton

U Street

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Late night Group

Madam's Organ

Adams Morgan; blues, since 1992

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Songbyrd Music House

Union Market

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

The Anthem

The Wharf; the venue

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Pearl Street Warehouse

The Wharf

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Union Stage

The Wharf

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Howard Theatre

Shaw

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Lincoln Theatre

U Street

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Blues Alley

Georgetown; jazz since 1965

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Twins Jazz

closed

Mr. Henry's

Capitol Hill; jazz

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

JoJo Restaurant & Bar

U Street; jazz

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Sotto

14th St; jazz basement

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Zeppelin karaoke

Shaw

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Late night Group

Muzette

Adams Morgan; karaoke

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Hill Prince

H Street

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Little Miss Whiskey's

H Street; upstairs dance floor

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Rock & Roll Hotel

closed

Wonderland Ballroom

Columbia Heights

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Dirty Habit late

Penn Quarter

\$\$\$
Late night Group

Barcode

Downtown

\$\$\$ SevenRooms
Late night Group

Clarendon Ballroom

Arlington

\$\$\$ SevenRooms
Late night Group

Spider Kelly's

Clarendon

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

*The Mall in the morning, Shaw and 14th Street after dark.
Everything by foot and Metro.*

You have one day between meetings, or one night before the train. Book one dinner; walk into everything else. **Book one thing: dinner at Albi (Resy, 30 days) — or The Dabney if Albi is gone.**

The day

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 8:00 | Yellow (Georgetown or Navy Yard)
The pistachio sticky bun and a coffee, then a pita breakfast sandwich if you're staying a while. Walk-in; the line moves. |
| <hr/> | |
| 9:30 | The Mall
Walk the Monument to the Lincoln Memorial before the school groups arrive. The museums are free; the cafés inside are on this list. |
| <hr/> | |
| 12:30 | Sweet Home Café (NMAAHC)
The best museum lunch in America — Carolina gold rice, smoked catfish, the fried chicken. Timed-entry passes for the museum are free but book online. |
| <hr/> | |
| 2:30 | Ben's Chili Bowl (U Street)
A half-smoke, all the way, at the counter where Obama ate. Cash is fastest. Then walk Shaw's murals down to Blagden Alley. |
| <hr/> | |
| 4:30 | Calico or Dabney Cellar (Blagden Alley)
A glass in the alley before dinner — Calico for the backyard, the Cellar for the wine list under The Dabney. |
| <hr/> | |
| 6:00 | Silver Lyan (Penn Quarter)
One cocktail in the Riggs bank vault — 50 Best №55. Book on Resy; the bar seats take walk-ins early. |
| <hr/> | |
| 7:30 | Albi (Navy Yard) ★
Michael Rafidi's wood-fired Levantine cooking: Washingtonian's №1 and the first four-star NYT restaurant outside New York. Resy, 30 days out. Backup: The Dabney ★ (Blagden Alley, hearth cooking, Resy) or Maydan (14th St, live fire, easier). |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:00 | Service Bar (U Street)
Walk-in, no fuss, some of the best drinks in the city (50 Best №23 last year). If it's packed, The Gibson is two blocks away — the original DC speakeasy. |

Three days

Downtown and Shaw, then Capitol Hill and the Wharf, then Georgetown and the West End. One quadrant a day.

A long weekend. Day one is the one-day plan; day two crosses to the Hill and the water; day three ends in Georgetown. **Book three dinners the morning reservations open: Albi, Rose's Luxury (or Pineapple & Pearls), and Fiola Mare or Xiquet.**

Day 1 · Downtown & Shaw

All day **Follow the one-day plan**
Yellow, the Mall, Sweet Home Café, Ben's, Blagden Alley, Silver Lyan, Albi, Service Bar.

Day 2 · Capitol Hill & the Wharf

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 8:30 | Eastern Market → Market Lunch
Blueberry-buckwheat pancakes at the counter, then the flea market outside if it's a weekend. Cash-friendly, walk-in, arrive before nine on Saturday. |
| 10:30 | The Capitol & the Library of Congress
Free tours; book the Capitol online. The Longworth cafeteria is the visitor's secret for a cheap, decent lunch among staffers. |
| 1:00 | Maine Avenue Fish Market (The Wharf)
The oldest open-air fish market in America. Jessie Taylor or Captain White's for a half-dozen oysters and a crab cake on the pier. Cash. |
| 3:00 | 12 Stories (InterContinental, The Wharf)
A drink twelve floors up over the Potomac and the Monument. Resy; the terrace fills at golden hour. |
| 5:30 | Little Pearl (Capitol Hill) ★
A glass of wine and pastries at the café before it turns into a tasting counter. Walk-in by day. |
| 7:30 | Rose's Luxury (Barracks Row) ★
Aaron Silverman's place, still the most fun starred room in the city. Resy, 30 days out, and the bar takes walk-ins from 5:00. Backup: Pineapple & Pearls ★ next door (Tock; the tasting menu) or Ambar (unlimited Balkan small plates, easier). |
| 10:00 | Harold Black or Wisdom (Barracks Row / Capitol Hill)
Harold Black is unmarked, Wisdom is all gin. Both a short walk. Or The Tune Inn — a dive since 1947 — for the honest version. |

Day 3 • Georgetown & the West End

9:00 **Baked & Wired (Georgetown)**

The cupcakes locals order instead of the ones with the line. Then walk the C&O Canal towpath.

11:00 **Georgetown → Dumbarton Oaks**

The gardens, then M Street. Martin's Tavern for a Bloody Mary in the booth where Kennedy proposed if you need a sit-down.

1:00 **Chez Billy Sud (Georgetown)**

Steak frites in the green room. Resy. Or Emma's Torch two blocks over — a refugee-trained kitchen that just made Resy's Hit List.

3:30 **Ching Ching Cha (Georgetown)**

Tea and dumplings in the tea house. Walk-in.

6:00 **Off the Record (Hay-Adams)**

The basement bar under the hotel across from the White House, where the deals get done. Walk-in; jackets not required but common.

7:30 **Fiola Mare (Georgetown Waterfront) or Xiquet (Glover Park) ★**

Fiola Mare for the seafood and the river; Xiquet for Danny Lledó's Valencian paella tasting. Resy / Tock, 30 days out. Backup: Rasika West End (the palak chaat; OpenTable) or Imperfecto ★ (West End; Resy).

10:00 **L'Annexe (Georgetown)**

The hidden bar under Chez Billy Sud, for one last drink. Or Blues Alley for the late set — jazz since 1965.

Five days

The three-day plan, plus the Ethiopian and Vietnamese neighborhoods, and one day for the splurge.

Enough time to eat like a resident: the outer neighborhoods, a tasting counter, the drag brunch, and a drive to the country. **This is a reservations trip. Set alarms for Albi, Rose's, minibar or Jônt, and — if you're driving — the Inn at Little Washington.**

Days 1–3

All **Follow the three-day plan**
Downtown, the Hill and the Wharf, Georgetown.

Day 4 · The neighborhoods

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 9:00 | La Tejana (Mount Pleasant)
Breakfast tacos from a window — a Bib Gourmand. Walk-in, cash-friendly, gone by noon. |
| 10:30 | Mount Pleasant → Columbia Heights
Bar del Monte if it's open for lunch (no reservations), Taqueria Habanero for the al pastor, Queen's English for Hong Kong noodles (both Bibs). |
| 1:00 | Eden Center (Falls Church; car or Metro to East Falls Church)
The Vietnamese mall: pho at Pho Xe Lua, bánh mì at Song Que, a coffee at Huong Binh. Cash at most counters. |
| 4:00 | Adams Morgan
Tryst for coffee on the couches, then Jack Rose's terrace for a whiskey from the 2,700-bottle wall. |
| 6:30 | Ethiopian on U Street & Shaw
Dukem, Zenebech or Chercher — the largest Ethiopian community outside Africa eats here. Order the veggie combo and a tibs; eat with your hands. Walk-in. Beteseb in Adams Morgan is the new-guard version (JBF semifinalist). |
| 9:00 | Green Zone → Death & Co DC (Adams Morgan)
Middle Eastern cocktails, then the New York bar's DC outpost. Resy for Death & Co; Green Zone walks in. |

Day 5 • The splurge, and Sunday

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 11:00 | Perry's drag brunch (Adams Morgan) or Le Diplomate (Logan Circle)
Perry's is the rooftop drag brunch that started DC's tradition (book weeks ahead); Le Diplomate is the brasserie brunch everyone else is at (Resy). |
| 2:00 | Union Market (NoMa)
The hall: Chai Pani for chaat, Buffalo & Bergen for an egg cream, Bidwell if you want a table. Then La'Shukran for a Levantine afternoon drink. |
| 4:30 | Summit (Conrad, CityCenter)
The Capitol-dome view, one drink. Resy. |
| 6:00 | Barmini (Penn Quarter)
José Andrés' cocktail lab, next door to minibar. Tock, reservation only; forty minutes is enough. |
| 8:00 | minibar ★★ or Jônt ★★
minibar for the José Andrés theater (Tock, weeks out); Jônt for Ryan Ratino's Japanese-leaning counter above Bresca (Tock). The country alternative: The Inn at Little Washington ★★ — ninety minutes' drive, book the room and stay. |
| 11:00 | Allegory (Eaton DC)
50 Best №57, behind the library door. Resy. Or Off the Record if you'd rather end where the day started. |

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

Reservations drop on a schedule.

Most Resy restaurants release 30 days out at 9 or 10am ET; Tock tables (minibar, Jônt, Pineapple & Pearls, Kinship/Métier, Nakazawa) go in blocks — set Notify. Rose's Luxury and Little Pearl hold bar seats for walk-ins; arrive at 5:00 for a 5:30 opening. The Inn at Little Washington is a Resy Global Dining Access restaurant — your Platinum card gets you tables the public can't see.

Cash still matters at the counters.

Ben's Chili Bowl, Horace & Dickie's, the Fish Market, Market Lunch, La Tejana and most of Eden Center are fastest or only in cash. Carry \$60 in small bills on the neighborhoods day.

Tip 20%; check for the service charge.

DC's tipped minimum wage has been rising under Initiative 82 and many restaurants now add a 3–20% service or 'I-82' charge — it's disclosed on the menu, and it is not the tip. Read the bill before adding 20% on top. Sales tax on meals is 10%.

The Metro is good, and it closes.

Tap in with a contactless card or phone (SmarTrip is optional now). Trains run until midnight Sunday–Thursday and 1am Friday–Saturday; after that it's a car. Georgetown has no Metro station — walk from Foggy Bottom or take the Circulator.

Security and dress codes.

The Capitol, the White House area and the museums are all bag-check; a small bag saves time. Off the Record, Round Robin and Quill don't enforce dress codes, but this is the most suit-wearing city in America and you'll feel it. Café Milano and the Waldorf expect an effort.

Monday is the dark day.

Most starred restaurants close Sunday and/or Monday — minibar, Jônt, Rose's, Pineapple & Pearls, The Dabney all do. Bars and the Ethiopian restaurants run seven days. Rooftops are seasonal; The Wharf's stay open into November with heaters.

Museums are free; their cafés aren't secret anymore.

Sweet Home Café at NMAAHC and Mitsitam at the American Indian museum are on this list on merit. The museum itself is free, but NMAAHC needs a timed pass — reserve online, or try the 8:15am same-day release.

The two cafeterias.

Anyone can eat at the Longworth House Office Building cafeteria (through security) and the Supreme Court cafeteria when the Court isn't sitting. Cheap, decent, and full of the people who run the country.

Use the Amex credit like a local.

Platinum: \$100 per quarter; Gold: \$50 twice a year. Pay with the enrolled card at any Resy or Tock venue showing the 'Resy Credit eligible' badge — no booking through Resy required. Check the quarter before the splurge night.

Anything marked verify, verify.

DC lost a record ~100 restaurants in 2025 and the churn continued into 2026 — Cranes, Reverie and Tail Up Goat among them. Thirty seconds on Resy or Google before you cross town.

Half-smoke, mumbo sauce, jumbo slice.

The half-smoke is a spiced pork-and-beef sausage — order it 'all the way' (chili, mustard, onions). Mumbo sauce is DC's sweet-tangy wing sauce, born in the carry-outs. The jumbo slice is an Adams Morgan 2am institution; it is not good, and that's not the point.

One for the road.

Union Station has Pearl's Bagels and a Blue Bottle; National airport has a Ben's Chili Bowl. Dulles has nothing on this list — eat before you go.

Notes

Michelin: the 2025 Washington, D.C. selection, announced November 18, 2025 in Philadelphia as part of the first Northeast Cities guide, holds twenty-five stars — three two-stars (minibar, Jônt, and the Inn at Little Washington, moved down from three) and twenty-two one-stars — and twenty-eight Bib Gourmands, with PhoXotic and Your Only Friend the two additions. No new stars were awarded, a first for the city. Three starred restaurants have since closed: Reverie (October 2025), Tail Up Goat (late 2025) and Cranes (February 2026).

Bars: North America's 50 Best Bars 2026 placed Silver Lyan (Nº55) and Allegory (Nº57) on its 51–100 list; Service Bar was Nº23 in 2025. Restaurant rankings are from Washingtonian's 100 Very Best Restaurants 2026 (Albi Nº1) and The Washington Post's 10 Best New Restaurants, published May 2026 by critic Elazar Sontag. James Beard marks are the 2026 nominations: Suresh Sundas of Taponi (Best Chef, Mid-Atlantic), Susan Bae of Moon Rabbit (Outstanding Pastry Chef), Chai Pani's Meherwan and Molly Irani (Outstanding Restaurateur), Maison Bar à Vins, Maxwell Park and Field & Main; semifinalists are noted where they matter.

Occasion chips for DC are editorial assignments, made by category and price, until a companion Guide by Occasion exists for the city. Booking platforms are listed as best known at time of printing; the Resy app is the source of truth for the Amex credit, which works the same way here as in New York.

Anything marked *verify* is a place whose current status couldn't be confirmed for this edition — DC lost a record number of restaurants in 2025 and the churn continued into 2026. Thirty seconds on Resy or Google before you get in a cab.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): six photographs, cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listedeville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.